

CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

**SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE
EXAMINATION**

**SPECIMEN
MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS
FOR**

GEOGRAPHY

GENERAL PROFICIENCY

READ THE FOLLOWING DIRECTIONS CAREFULLY

Each item in this test has four suggested answers lettered (A), (B), (C), (D). Read each item you are about to answer and decide which choice is best.

Sample Item

Hurricanes in the Caribbean area are MOST likely to occur during

- (A) February - April
- (B) April - June
- (C) July - September
- (D) October - February

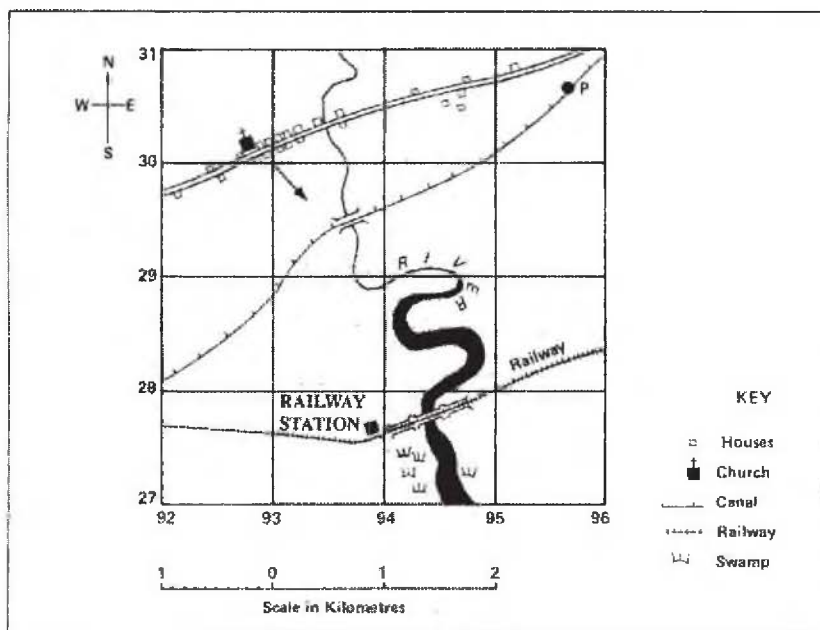
Sample Answer



The best answer to this item is "July - September", so answer space (C) has been shaded.

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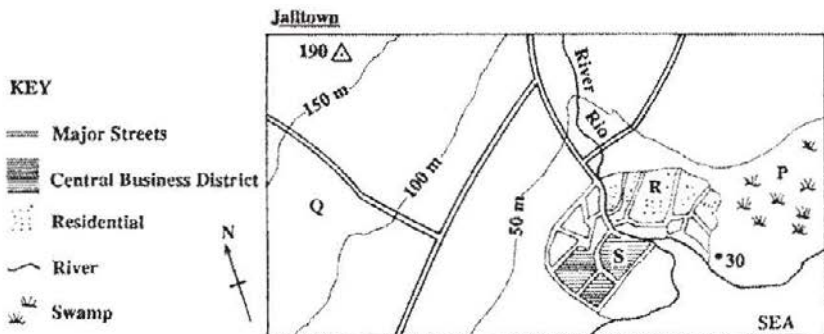
Items 1 - 5 refer to the following map.



1. What is the grid reference of Point P?
 (A) 307957
 (B) 305954
 (C) 954305
 (D) 957307
2. The straight-line distance, in km, between the church and the railway station is
 (A) 2.2
 (B) 2.8
 (C) 3.0
 (D) 3.8
3. In which direction is the arrow on the map pointing?
 (A) South-east
 (B) South-west
 (C) East-south-east
 (D) South-south-east
4. The man-made feature running south-west through P is a
 (A) road
 (B) canal
 (C) railway
 (D) swamp
5. The settlement pattern in the map is BEST described as being
 (A) dispersed
 (B) isolated
 (C) linear
 (D) nucleated

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

Items 6 - 10 refer to the following map extract on a scale of 1 : 100 000



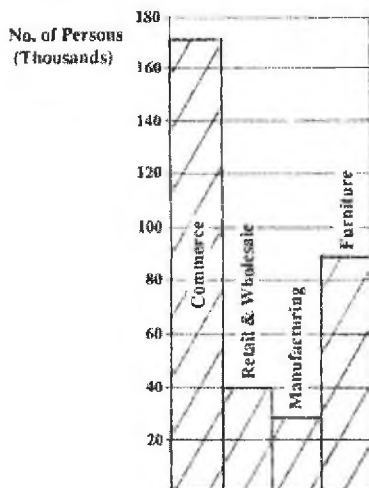
6. Which of the following features of Jalltown are the BEST reasons for its location?
- I. It is on flat land.
 - II. It has a supply of fresh water.
 - III. It is near to the swamp.
 - IV. It is on the sea coast.
- (A) I, II and III only
(B) I, II and IV only
(C) II, III and IV only
(D) I, II, III and IV
7. A prospective buyer of a house is BEST advised to search in area
- (A) P
(B) Q
(C) R
(D) S
8. What is the general direction of flow of the river shown in the diagram above?
- (A) West to east
(B) East to west
(C) South to north
(D) North to south
9. The width of the contour interval is
- (A) 50 m
(B) 100m
(C) between 50 and 150 m
(D) between 50 and 190 m
10. Where would the land value be HIGHEST on the sketch map?
- (A) P
(B) Q
(C) R
(D) S

11. What time is it likely to be at Town X (15° E) when it is 10 a.m. at Greenwich (0°)?

- (A) 9.00 a.m.
(B) 9.30 a.m.
(C) 10.30 a.m.
(D) 11.00 a.m.

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

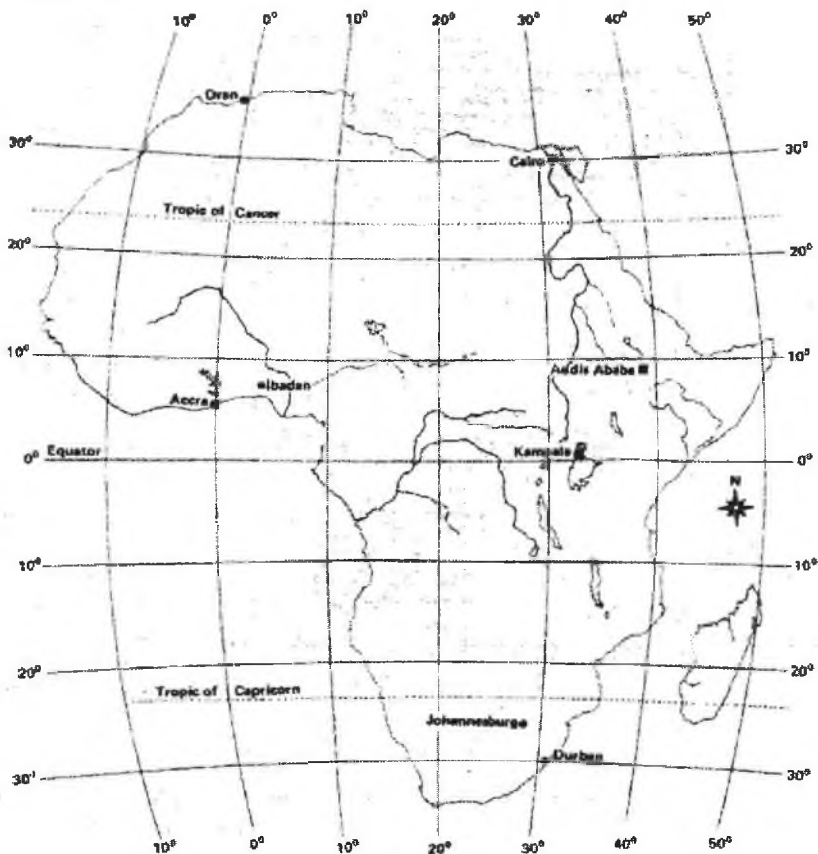
Items 12 - 14 are based on the bar graph below which shows employment figures for several business sectors in a Caribbean territory.



12. What is the TOTAL number of persons employed in the manufacturing and furniture sectors?
- (A) 90 000
(B) 100 000
(C) 120 000
(D) 130 000
13. According to the information from the bar graph above which of the following is NOT true?
- (A) The manufacturing sector employs the least number of people.
(B) More than one-half of the entire business sector is employed in commerce.
(C) The retail and wholesale sector employs less than half of the number of people employed in furniture.
(D) The two sectors, furniture and retail and wholesale, employ more people than commerce.
14. What is the TOTAL number of persons employed in the four sectors shown in the bar graph above?
- (A) 310 000
(B) 320 000
(C) 330 000
(D) 350 000

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

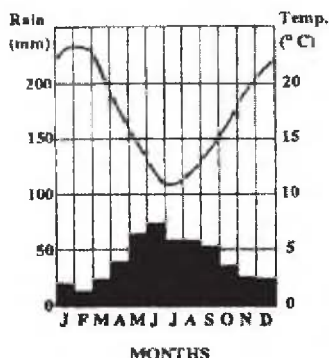
Items 15 - 16 refer to the following map:



15. The MOST accurate location for the city of Durban is
- latitude 30°S, longitude 31°E
 - latitude 31°S, longitude 29°E
 - latitude 29°N, longitude 29°W
 - latitude 29°N, longitude 31°W
16. Which of the following cities lie South of 0° latitude?
- Oran
 - Accra
 - Durban
 - Johannesburg
- I and III only
 - III and IV only
 - II, III and IV only
 - I, II, III and IV

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

Items 17 -19 refer to the rainfall and temperature graph below.



17. The TWO wettest months of the year indicated in the graph shown above are

(A) May and June
(B) July and August
(C) January and February
(D) November and December

18. The annual range of temperature is APPROXIMATELY

(A) 3°C
(B) 5°C
(C) 12°C
(D) 19°C

19. Which of the following statements is true?

(A) The hottest months of the year are also the wettest.
(B) The hottest months of the year are also the driest.
(C) There is little variation in temperature throughout the year.
(D) There is little variation in rainfall throughout the year.

20. Isobars are lines drawn on a map which join places experiencing the same

(A) annual rainfall
(B) relative humidity
(C) atmospheric pressure
(D) mean annual temperature

21. The formation of young fold mountains is NOT explained by

(A) upwelling of magma to form new plates
(B) deposition of sediments in a shallow basin
(C) compression of sediments by colliding plates
(D) elevation of sediments into anticlines and synclines

22. Which of the statements below describes basic lava?

I. Flows easily
II. Erupts explosively
III. Forms a shield volcano
IV. Has high percentage of iron

(A) I, II and III
(B) I, III and IV
(C) II, III and IV
(D) All of the above

23. Sea floor spreading occurs at the

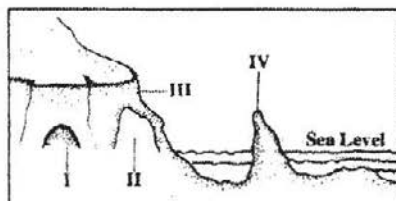
(A) mid-Atlantic ridge
(B) Windward Passage
(C) floor of the Puerto Rico trench
(D) junction of the Caribbean and Cocos plates

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

24. Which of the following relief features is a result of plate tectonic activity in the Caribbean?

(A) Aripo Plains in Trinidad
(B) Palisadoes Spit in Jamaica
(C) Rupununi Savannas in Guyana
(D) Soufrière in St. Vincent

Items 25 - 26 refer to the diagram below.



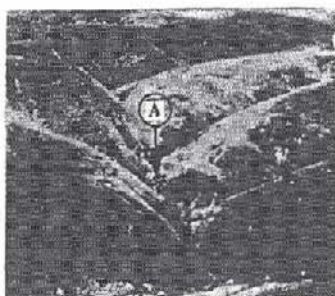
25. The CORRECT order of the features identified by I, II, III, IV, on the diagram above is

(A) cave, arch, cliff, stack
(B) arch, cave, stack, cliff
(C) stack, cliff, arch, cave
(D) cliff, cave, stack, arch

26. Which of the following processes is NOT likely to be an important agent in the formation of the labelled features, I, II, III, IV, on the diagram above?

(A) Abrasion
(B) Corrosion
(C) Deposition
(D) Hydraulic action

Items 27 - 28 refer to the photograph below.



27. The valley labelled A in the photograph above is MOST likely formed as a result of

(A) folding
(B) faulting
(C) running water
(D) mass movement

28. Which of the following BEST describes the pattern formed by the sides of the valley in the photograph above?

(A) Meanders
(B) Terraces
(C) Knick-points
(D) Interlocking spurs

29. Which of the following groups contains ONLY processes of wind erosion?

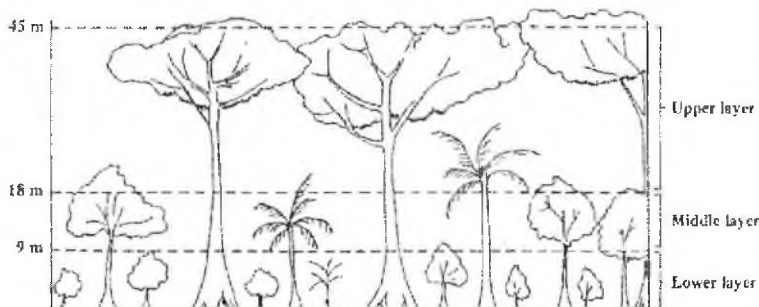
(A) Abrasion, deflation, attrition
(B) Corrosion, attrition, plucking
(C) Plucking, corrosion, deflation
(D) Deflation, abrasion, hydraulic action

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

30. Which of the following conditions may result from man's utilization of the natural environment?
- Soil erosion
 - Pollution
 - Depletion of natural resources
- I and II only
 - I and III only
 - II and III only
 - I, II and III
31. Which of the following statements is NOT true about waves?
- They are caused by wind blowing over the surface of the water.
 - On nearing the beach, the speed of waves slackens and the tops are thrown forward.
 - On approaching the coast, the body of water forming the waves increases rapidly.
 - The stronger the wind and the greater the fetch, the more powerful the waves are.
32. It is most likely that recent hurricanes in the Caribbean have caused fewer deaths because
- families no longer live in unsafe areas
 - many hurricanes have occurred during the day
 - the majority of the population goes to storm shelters
 - there have been improved forecasts of hurricane tracks
33. The process in which water vapour cools and forms water droplets is termed
- evaporation
 - condensation
 - convection
 - precipitation
34. The MOST important factor explaining the difference between weather and climate is
- location
 - rainfall
 - temperature
 - time
35. Tropical or easterly waves in the Caribbean are MOST common during the months
- June to July
 - May to October
 - December to March
 - November to December
36. Four climatic features are listed below.
- Low pressure all the year around
 - High annual rainfall, mostly convectional
 - Small annual range of temperature
 - High average daily temperature
- Which of the following climatic types is characterized by ALL of the features described above?
- Equatorial
 - Tropical Marine
 - Tropical Continental
 - Cool Temperature Interior
37. The concentration of minerals in the lower layers of a soil profile is the result of
- erosion
 - leaching
 - capillarity
 - illuviation
38. Which of the following is NOT likely to result from slash and burn agriculture on steep slopes?
- Erosion of slopes
 - Flooding on lowlands
 - Deeper soil on slopes
 - Rapid downhill movement of water

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

Items 39 - 40 refer to the diagram below which shows the three layers in an equatorial forest.



39. Plants which grow in the lower layer are adapted to growing in
- (A) low humidity
(B) shaded areas
(C) bright sunlight
(D) windy conditions
40. The trees which grow in the upper layers have buttress roots MAINLY because the
- (A) creepers grow around the trees
(B) rainfall is heavy
(C) temperatures are high
(D) trees are tall
-
41. Which of the following are ways in which natural vegetation adapts to climatic conditions?
- I. Development of water-storage organs
II. Shedding of leaves during the dry season
III. Development of long roots
IV. Development of special types of leaves
- (A) I and II only
(B) III and IV only
(C) I, II and III only
(D) I, II, III and IV
42. Island B has an area of 20 km^2 and a population of 1000 people. What is the population density of Island B?
- (A) $\frac{1}{50}$ per km^2
(B) 50 per km^2
(C) 500 per km^2
(D) 20 000 per km^2

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

43. Which of the following areas would have its **HIGHEST** population density in the daytime?

(A) A rural fishing village
(B) A squatter settlement
(C) An urban commercial centre
(D) An urban residential area

44. The table below shows birth and death rates for Country A in 2000.

Birth Rate per 1000	Death Rate per 1000
20	15

For 2000, the natural increase in Country A is

(A) 0.005%
(B) 0.5%
(C) 3.5%
(D) 5.0%

45. Which of the following terms **BEST** explains the rapid growth in size of **MOST** urban centres in the Caribbean?

(A) An ageing population
(B) An increase in the number of immigrants
(C) High birth rates and low infant mortality
(D) The migration of persons from rural areas

46. Which of the following features are characteristic of peasant farms in the Caribbean?

I. Small holdings
II. Large holdings
III. Family labour
IV. Local market

(A) I and III only
(B) I and IV only
(C) I, III and IV only
(D) II, III and IV only

47. Which of the following statements is true of subsistence farming?

(A) Individual farms are quite small.
(B) Yields per farmer are generally high.
(C) Large amounts of fertilisers are used on the farm.
(D) Crop cultivation is not as important as animal rearing.

48. Commercial pastoral farming in Caribbean territories is **LEAST** likely to take place near urban settlements because

(A) the size of population is too small to support this activity
(B) the soil in these locations is infertile
(C) there is easy transmission of animal diseases to humans
(D) there are no large areas of land for grazing

49. Which of the following factors has **NOT** contributed to the development of the garment industry in the Caribbean?

(A) Availability of local raw materials
(B) Incentives by local governments
(C) The need for more job opportunities
(D) The presence of local and regional markets

50. Which of the following considerations is **LEAST** important in choosing a location for a fishing industry?

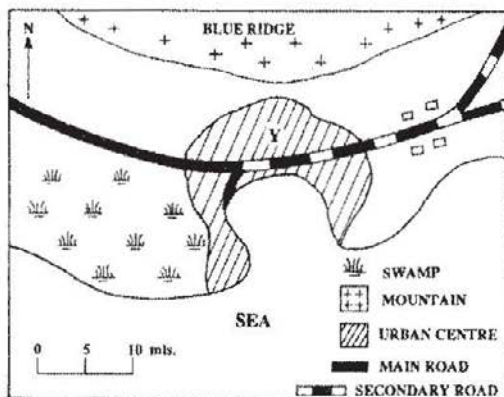
(A) A large labour force
(B) Nearness to the sea
(C) Adequate marketing facilities
(D) Adequate storage facilities

51. Which of the following is the **MAIN** reason why flour mills in the Caribbean are situated on coastal locations?

(A) Availability of cheap labour
(B) Availability of cheap power supply
(C) Nearness to the waste disposal facilities
(D) Nearness to facilities for unloading raw materials

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

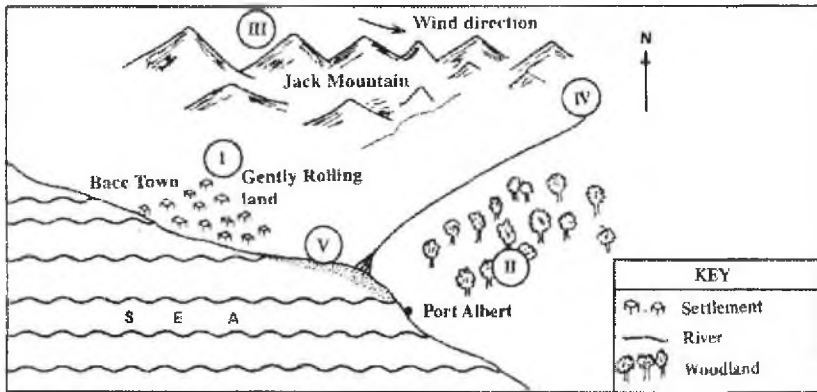
Items 52 - 53 are based on the following sketch map.



52. Which of the following features BEST explain why the urban centre in the sketch map above is located at Y?
- I. The presence of flat land
 - II. The nearness to the mountains
 - III. The presence of a natural harbour
- (A) I and II only
 (B) I and III only
 (C) II and III only
 (D) I, II and III
53. In which direction is the urban centre MOST likely to expand?
- (A) East
 - (B) West
 - (C) North
 - (D) South

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

Items 54 - 55 are based on the following sketch map.



54. Which of the areas, labelled (I), (II), (IV) and (V), is MOST LIKELY to be developed as a tourist resort?
- (A) I
(B) II
(C) IV
(D) V
55. Which of the areas, labelled (I), (II), (III) and (IV), would be the BEST area for locating a new factory in order to minimize the effects of air pollution?
- (A) I
(B) II
(C) III
(D) IV

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

56. The main reasons for urbanization in the Caribbean are
- natural increase of the population in the cities
 - expectation of more jobs in the cities
 - migration from rural areas to urban areas
 - migration from urban areas to rural areas
- (A) I and III only
(B) I and IV only
(C) I, II and III only
(D) I, III and IV only
57. Agriculture is an important economic activity in the Caribbean because
- it is heavily mechanized
 - it employs a significant percentage of people
 - government allocates a significant portion of its budget to the sector
 - it accounts for a significant portion of the foreign exchange earnings in many countries
58. Many garment industries in the Caribbean are closing business MAINLY because
- the demand for clothes is falling
 - cheaper imports are entering the region
 - the rates for wages are lower in South-East Asia and Mexico
 - many women refuse to work in the factories
59. In the long-term, volcanic eruptions can have beneficial effects to a country by
- relocating people to new areas in the country
 - producing deposits of gold, copper and other minerals
 - providing sources of energy to be used for electricity needs
 - bringing new materials to the earth's surface which produce rich soils
- (A) I only
(B) I, II and IV only
(C) I, III and IV only
(D) II, III and IV only
60. In advance of the approach of a hurricane, risk to lives can be reduced by
- relocating people to shelters
 - evacuating people living in low-lying areas
 - encouraging people to stock up on fresh supply
 - encouraging people to acquire generators for their energy needs
- (A) I and II only
(B) III and IV only
(C) I, II and III only
(D) All of the above

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE